

Google Play Store version 4.6.16 out with better in-app purchase protection

Google has rolled out a new update for the Play Store. Version 4.6.16 of the client has some really nice features including mass install support and the much needed option to always ask for a password for in-app purchases.

Batch install support should make life much easier whenever you're loading all of your apps onto a new phone. You can now select multiple apps by going to *My Apps < All* and install them in one go. You will obviously need to individually accept app permissions first. The updated Play Store client now also comes with the option of 'Always ask password for purchases'. This replaces the earlier on/off toggle for dealing with passwords for purchases. The change should be particularly useful for parents whose children often use their phones.

Qualcomm announces LTE integrated 64-bit Snapdragon chips

Qualcomm has reportedly launched its 64-bit eight-core Snapdragon chips. The mobile chips are called the 600 Series and come with LTE network handling.

The new 64-bit mobile chip is noted to be faster than Apple's equivalent. The 601 is pin compatible with the slower Snapdragon 401, which implies that the manufacturers can swap it out with ease, without much engineering. The cores are ARMv8 compatible, which are backward-compatible with 32-bit applications. This is a consideration, since there is very little that runs at 64 bits in the non-iOS ecosystem.

The chip will be available in the market in October, this year, and the company is likely to start shipping by next year. The new Snapdragon chip has a 1.5GHz speed, and the 600 Series will also have Qualcomm's Adreno 405 GPU that will bring DirectX 11.2 and Open GL ES.3.0 to phones.

Here's an all new ARM-based Linux PC!

UK-based Cloudsto has launched a new ARM-based Linux computer. The Rikomagic MK902 LE comes pre-loaded with Ubuntu Linux and is available via the Cloudsto shop for around US\$ 159. Meanwhile, there's also an Android version available, which can be purchased from Geekbuying and AliExpress for around US\$ 105.

The Rikomagic MK902 LE is powered by a Rockchip RK3188 ARM Cortex-A9 quad-core processor along with 2 GB of RAM. The device comes with 8 GB or 16 GB of storage, further expandable via a microSD card slot. Connectivity options include HDMI, four full-sized USB ports, 802.11n Wi-Fi and 10/100 Ethernet. It comes preloaded with PiCuntu 4.5, which is a custom version of Ubuntu 13.04 made for devices that run on Rockchip processors.

Basic Ubuntu apps work pretty well on the Rikomagic MK902 LE. However, in case you're looking for an immersive multimedia experience, the device is simply not meant for you. RK3188 chips are known to offer no support for hardware-accelerated graphics or video; therefore, gaming and video playback on the device is not something to boast about, and clearly, the company doesn't intend to do more on this front. If you're looking for a 'better' multimedia device, the Android version might be better suited for your needs.

Google to launch Android 4.5, Nexus 8 in July

Google is hosting the I/O 2014 developer conference from June 25-26, but the company is likely to make the big announcements about its upcoming products in July. Google has, so far, revealed no plans to bring out a new update in the Android OS at its yearly event.

The Android maker is expected to officially launch the Android 4.5 version with a new tablet, touted to be the Nexus 8, in the month of July.

No further details on the new Nexus 8 have been revealed yet. Google may establish the 20.3-cm (8-inch) Nexus 8 tablet by the end of April with primary shipments of two million units, and ASUS might again be the partner in the development of the new Android-powered tablet.

Google is also reported to have dropped development of a 17.7-cm (7-inch) Nexus tablet, succumbing to the heavy competition in the segment. The company will now try to focus on the 20.3-cm (8-inch) segment, since this segment has less competition. At the moment, the most notable 20.3-cm tablets in the market are from Samsung—the Galaxy Note 8.0 and Galaxy Tab Pro 8.4, and G Pad 8.3 from LG.

LibreOffice version 4.2.1 is out!

The Document Foundation has announced a minor update for LibreOffice, OSS' very own answer to Microsoft Office. LibreOffice version 4.2.1 comes with some changed and added menu entries, as the release note states. The update follows LibreOffice 4.2.

"LibreOffice 4.2 was extremely ambitious, in terms of code refactoring. Because of this, we planned an extensive quality assurance cycle, based on automated tests followed by QA sprints in December and January, but we were not able to catch all the issues. Based on early adopters' feedback, developers and QA experts have jumped in immediately, and have solved the most urgent problems in less than three weeks, showing the importance of our large community," Thorsten Behrens, chairman, Document Foundation was quoted as saying. LibreOffice 4.2.1 for Windows will allow multiple user interface languages. Meanwhile, the Mac version has done away with the mediawiki extension.

LibreOffice 4.2 was targeted towards early adopters and was another significant step forward for the best free office suite ever.